



MATHEMATICS

# Two-Step Story Problem Task Cards

Grade 3 | Task Cards

Solve and represent two-step problems, then check whether answers are reasonable.

## INSIDE THIS RESOURCE

Teacher guidance • 16 practice prompts • Reflection exit ticket • Complete answer guidance

Print the practice pages separately from the teacher key. Provide extra paper for extended work.



## Teacher guide

NC.3.OA.8 - Solve two-step word problems using addition, subtraction, and multiplication, representing problems with equations containing a symbol for the unknown.

Suggested time: 35-45 minutes

Learning focus: Solve and represent two-step problems, then check whether answers are reasonable.

Teaching sequence: Review prior instruction and model the first prompt with its answer. Assign one four-prompt page at a time. Ask for a check, a reason, or a specific example. Use the reflection ticket to plan the next lesson; it is not a standardized mastery score.

Model prompt: A class packs 6 boxes with 8 markers each, then gives away 15 markers. How many remain?

Model answer: 33

## Support options

AIG: justify a second method or create a transfer example. 504: follow the learner's plan for time, breaks, format, and reduced copying. EC: model steps and accept aligned oral, drawn, or written responses. ESL: preview vocabulary, use bilingual references, and rehearse before writing.

Source and scope: North Carolina Department of Public Instruction, Mathematics Standards Vertical Progression: <https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/publications/catalog/ma196-vertical-progression-math/open>; NC Check-Ins 2.0

Mathematics Specifications:

<https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/accountability/testing/nc-checkin/nc-check-ins-20-mathematics-grades-3-8-specifications> (accessed September 14, 2026).



## Practice 1–4

Show work or explain your response. Use additional paper when needed. Teachers may cut apart the four bordered prompts.

1. A class packs 6 boxes with 8 markers each, then gives away 15 markers. How many remain?

2. Mia reads 24 pages Monday and 18 Tuesday. Her book has 70 pages. How many remain?

3. Four teams collect 9 cans each and then collect 17 more. Total?

4. A garden has 7 rows with 9 plants each. Three plants in each row do not bloom. How many plants bloom?



## Practice 5–8

Show work or explain your response. Use additional paper when needed. Teachers may cut apart the four bordered prompts.

5. A store had 85 notebooks, sold 29, then received 40. How many now?

6. Five buses carry 7 students each. Twelve more arrive by car. Total?

7. Write an equation for 9 bags of 4 apples with 11 apples eaten.

8. A player earns 8 points in each of 3 rounds and loses 5 penalty points. Score?



## Practice 9–12

Show work or explain your response. Use additional paper when needed. Teachers may cut apart the four bordered prompts.

9. Lena has \$50, buys two games at \$14 each. Money left?

10. A baker makes 72 rolls and sells 4 trays with 8 rolls each. How many rolls remain?

11. Choose the first operation: 6 shelves hold 5 books each; 9 are borrowed.

12. Explain how to check  $7 \times 6 + 18 = 60$ .



## Practice 13–16

Show work or explain your response. Use additional paper when needed. Teachers may cut apart the four bordered prompts.

13. Create a two-step problem with answer 26.

14. A student says  $4 \times 9 - 7 = 29$ . Is the student correct?

15. Estimate whether  $8 \times 6 + 13$  could equal 90.

16. Represent: 45 stickers shared among 5 students, then each gets 2 more.



## Reflection exit ticket

Complete independently. Refer to your completed practice, but explain in your own words. This checks reflection and application, not a test score prediction.

1. State the focus of this resource in your own words.
2. Create one accurate example connected to the practice.
3. Explain how you checked that example.
4. Identify one possible error and show a correction.
5. Name one specific next practice step and explain why it will help.



## Teacher answer guidance

1. 33
2. 28
3. 53
4.  $7 \times (9 - 3) = 42$  blooming plants.
5. 96
6. 47
7.  $9 \times 4 - 11 = 25$
8. 19
9. \$22
10.  $72 - 4 \times 8 = 40$  rolls remain.
11. Multiply  $6 \times 5$
12.  $42 + 18 = 60$ ; reverse with  $60 - 18 = 42$
13. Answers vary; both operations and equation required.
14. Yes;  $36 - 7 = 29$
15. No;  $48 + 13 = 61$
16.  $45 / 5 + 2 = 11$

### Reflection criteria

Items 1–4: 2 points for an accurate, specific response; 1 for a partly correct response; 0 for a missing or unrelated response. Accept justified alternatives. Item 5 is an unscored planning reflection. Feedback should identify a next teaching move, not label a learner.

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